Alexander Nicholas

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EDUCATION

California State University San Marcos **2021-2025**
B.S. Computer Science *GPA: 3.68*
Honors and Awards: Dean's List - Spring 2022 to Fall 2024
ABET Accredited Program
Relevant Coursework: Computer Networking, Cybersecurity, Machine Learning, Data Structures and Algorithms, Software Engineering

SKILLS

- Systems and Support: Windows Server, Virtual Machines, Linux/Unix, Hardware and Software Troubleshooting, OSI Model Troubleshooting, Technical Documentation
- Networking and Infrastructure: Computer Networking, VLANs, 3D Modeling, Network Segmentation, Firewall Rules, Docker
- Tools and Development: Git, Python, SQL, JavaScript, C/C++, HTML/CSS, Agile, Microsoft Excel, Word, PowerPoint

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA A+, CompTIA - August 2026 (valid through August 2029)
In progress: CompTIA Network+ and CompTIA Security+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

California State University San Marcos **January 2025 - May 2025**
Instructional Student Assistant *San Marcos, CA*
- Evaluated and recorded grades for 250+ Theory of Computing assignments and projects across 100+ students, applying course rubrics consistently and meeting 98% of grading deadlines.
- Delivered individualized written feedback on automata, grammars, computability, and proof-based work, helping students identify recurring errors and strengthen problem-solving approaches.
- Partnered with the course instructor to clarify rubric criteria and resolve 20+ grading questions, improving consistency across assignment cycles.
- Managed 2-5 hours of weekly grading alongside a full academic course load while maintaining a one to two week turnaround on student work.

Pfizer **May 2023 - August 2023**
Quality Assurance Intern *Remote*
- Contributed to the Pfizer Digital organization as a remote intern, collaborating with the Franklin group on enhancing web publishing platforms for improved user engagement.
- Executed Quality Assurance Testing for IT platforms, checking functionality and performance through systematic checks and documentation.
- Developed and refined technical documentation for digital platforms to improve clarity and usability for end-users.
- Reviewed digital project requirements and outcomes to support alignment with organizational goals.

PROJECTS & OUTSIDE EXPERIENCE

IT & Cybersecurity Home Lab **September 2025 - Present**
Personal infrastructure lab
- Configured a managed network switch with VLANs to segment and isolate traffic across multiple virtual machines.
- Deployed and administered Windows Server and Linux environments for systems administration practice.
- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi cluster, provisioning each node with Linux and configuring persistent, automatically mounted data storage.
- Troubleshot network and system issues using a systematic OSI-layer methodology.
- Maintained detailed lab documentation covering configurations, commands, and lessons learned.

Facial Expression Classification **March 2025 - May 2025**
Academic team project / reproducible benchmark *Portfolio update: October 2026*
- Implemented and tuned the coursework SVM with GridSearchCV, contributing feature engineering, visualizations, code consolidation, and reporting.
- Updated the benchmark with Codex assistance: 981 CK+-derived rows, 25 corrected geometric features, and Decision Tree, SVM, and PyTorch MLP comparisons against a majority baseline.
- Recorded deterministic split manifests and kept preprocessing and resampling inside training folds to avoid validation leakage.
- Compared image-level and inferred related-frame group splits; SVM test macro F1 was 0.9897 versus 0.6230. Documented that neither protocol measures unseen-person performance.